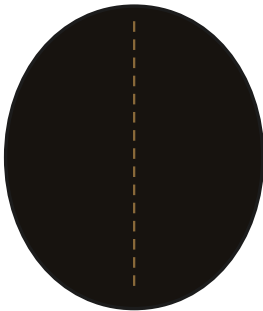


Body ×1

black · the oval wing-cases · actual size



dashed = centre line (guide, don't cut)

Shield & head

black · actual size



shield (pronotum) ×1 · sits behind the head



head ×1 · the fan of teeth is the clypeus — its dung-and-sand shovel

Legs ×6

black · actual size



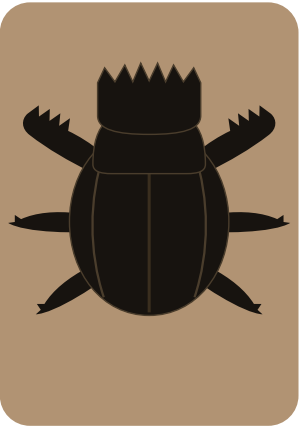
front legs ×2 · broad & toothed for digging



middle & back legs ×4 · stout & spiny

Finished!

the same pieces, assembled



oval body · shield · toothed head · 6 legs · ≈ 5.5 × 5 cm

The real thing



Scarabaeus sacer
— the Sacred Scarab,
a dung beetle.

Photo © Blanchemain Joël, CC0,
via iNaturalist. Taken at Targante,
Morocco — this Mediterranean
species isn't found near Manchester,
or anywhere in Britain.

Did you know?

- It rolls balls of dung, then buries them as food for its grubs.
- Ancient Egyptians thought it sacred — a sign of the sun and of rebirth.
- It can steer by the sun, the moon and even the Milky Way.
- The toothed edge on its head works like a little shovel.
- It lives around the Mediterranean — not in Britain.

How to make it

from your felt squares

- 1 Trace each shape onto the black felt.
- 2 Cut out all 9 pieces.
- 3 Build it on the mat →

Felt squares you'll use:

-  black — body, shield, head, legs
-  brown — the soil mat

Brown soil mat / pouch is premade — every felt piece on it is black.

Build it

lay the pieces on the mat

- 1 Lay the brown mat down — that's the soil.
- 2 Place the oval body, then the shield above it.
- 3 Add the toothed head at the very front.

Nothing is fixed — the pieces just sit like a jigsaw.

...and again

it's a puzzle, not a glue-up

- 4 Tuck the 6 legs under — three each side.
- 5 Put the two broad legs at the front for digging.
- 6 Done! Take it apart and build it all again.

Try giving your scarab a little felt ball of "dung" to roll!

At a glance

9 felt pieces

- 1 body (black)
- 1 shield / pronotum (black)
- 1 toothed head (black)
- 6 legs (black)
— 2 broad front + 4 stout

Finished size

≈ 5.5 × 5 cm

Theme: Underground. Collect the scarab, and more beetles to come.



A Giant Insect World felt puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again



FuzzleWorld

downloadable felt puzzle kits

Collect the set

Meadow · Aquatic · Underground
Beetles

ladybird · dragonfly · earthworm
sacred scarab · more to come...

Species: Scarabaeus sacer · Photo
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Giant Insect World